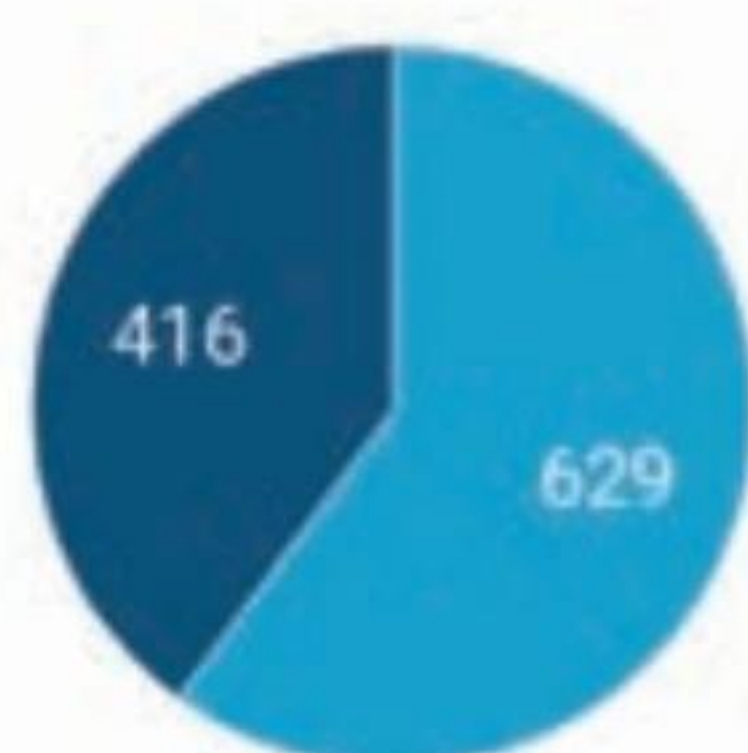
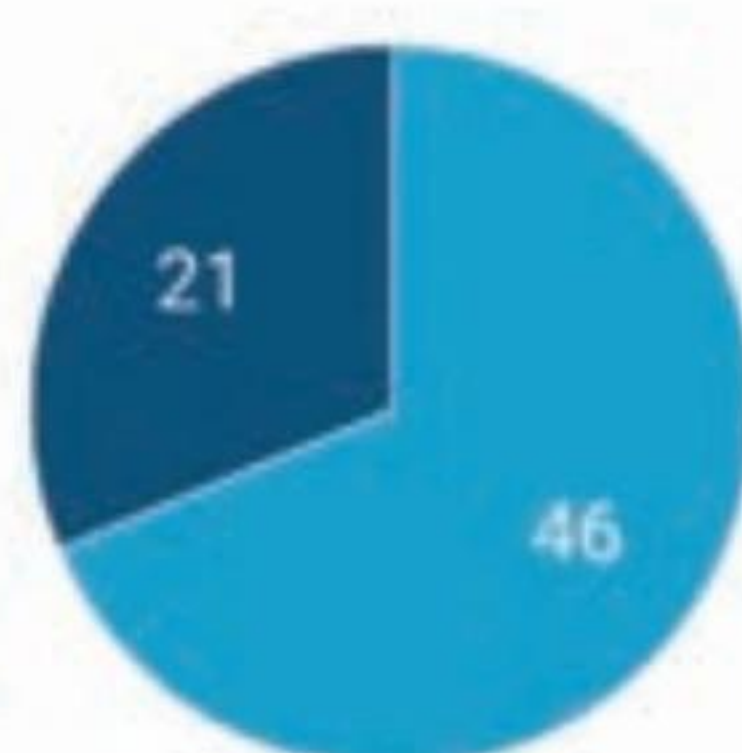


Spinners in death overs (IPL 2024 vs 2025)

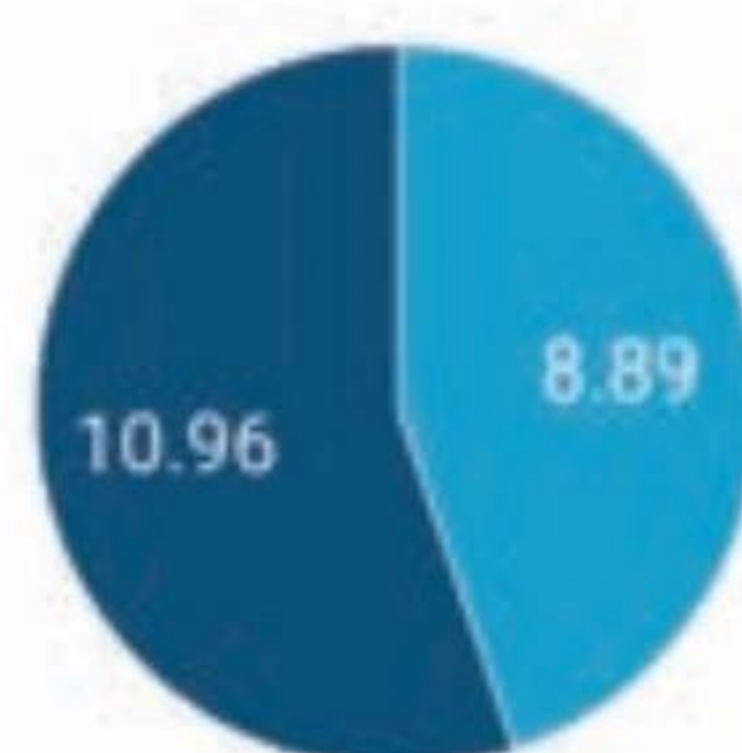
2025 2024



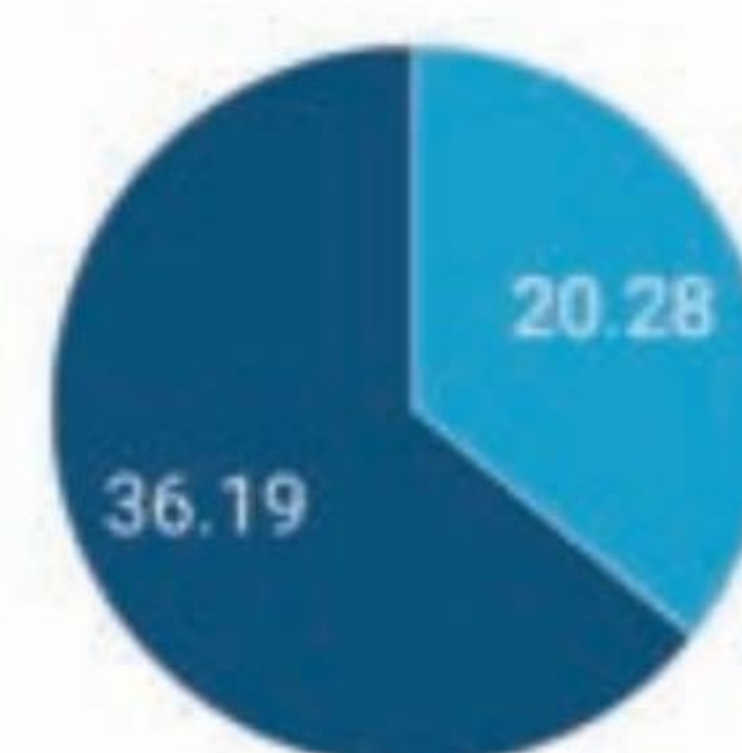
Balls bowled



Wickets



Economy Rate



Average

Beyond the PowerPlay

The inability of certain teams to adapt to conditions has also led to stagnating run rates this season. A case in point is Sunrisers Hyderabad, an outlier last season which turbocharged scoring rates with consistent onslaughts in the PowerPlay. It struck at a whopping 11.17 in the first six overs in 2024, followed by defending champion Kolkata Knight Riders (11.07) and Delhi Capitals (10.67). None of these teams have managed to replicate that ball-striking ability this season, with KKR and DC unable to find the right combination and the famed duo of Abhishek Sharma and Travis Head far from their marauding best.

SRH seamer Jaydev Unadkat attributed his side's falling stocks to tougher pitches and acknowledged that bowlers and their plans are constantly evolving.

"Last year, we scored 200-plus in four or five [six] matches, and that gave us a sense that we had set a standard. But that can't always be the norm. Other teams and batters are planning better now, and bowlers are also adapting and coming up with new strategies. Last year, swing was enough to make an impact, but this year, it's about using variations effectively. Also, the pitches are playing a big role. Last year we had a lot of flat pitches, whereas this time we've had more difficult ones," he said.

Bowlers have used the pitch more and relied on swing less in the PowerPlay this year. The number of full deliveries has reduced by over 40 per cent compared to 2024, while the short and back-of-a-length deliveries have increased by 11.13 per cent and 37.14 per cent, respectively.

The PowerPlay run rates may have only dipped marginally between 2024 and 2025, from 9.46 to 9.44, but the bowlers have managed to avoid astronomical totals in the first six overs. Five of the top 10 PowerPlay scores in IPL history were set in 2024, while only two from 2025 have made it to that list so far.

Bowlers in the ascendancy?

In IPL 2024, the tournament's two most aggressive batting units — Sunrisers Hyderabad and Kolkata Knight Riders — had reached the final.

Despite IPL 2025 almost matching last season's scoring rates, the better bowling attacks are dominating this year. Mumbai Indians and Royal Challengers Bengaluru, the most economical sides after 50 matches, are first and second, respectively, in the standings.

And that has been the beauty of this season: while the batters flirt with unscaled heights, the bowlers keep them grounded.

Venue-wise run rates (IPL 2024 vs 2025)

2024 2025

